

SALES TRAINING DEBRIEF · SESSION 5

Discipline is the Multiplier. You're the Operator Now.

Session led by Corie Dawson, Director

Wednesday 13 May 2026 · Internal sales-team summary

The thesis in one line

The team is better than it has ever been. Results are down. The variable that changed is not the people — it is the habits. Discipline drove the peak, discipline drifted away, results followed. This session is also a leadership handover: Corie steps back into an investor role, and the senior reps step forward as the operators of the business. From now on you don't wait to be coached; you decide when to deploy coaching as a resource.

"Bad boss: you work for me. Good boss: I work for you. When you need me deployed, deploy me." — Corie

1. The leadership reframe

The first major shift announced in this session is structural. Corie is repositioning himself as an investor in the company rather than its day-to-day operator. The three senior reps are repositioned as the business owners running the show.

What changes in practice

Old dynamic	New dynamic
Senior rep is an employee waiting for direction	Senior rep is the operator of their own business inside the company
Corie drives the daily standup and training	Senior reps drive the standup and training; Corie is deployed when needed
Wait for Corie to identify what's broken	Identify what's broken yourself; pitch the solution to Corie like an investor
Look up the chain for permission	Take initiative; report what you're doing and why
"Tell me what to do next"	"Here's what we're going to do — do you back it?"

Why this matters

If you want to be the boss, you have to act like one. That means coming with ideas, motivation, discipline, and a willingness to be hard on the team where needed. The most

common failure mode in this transition is to want the title without wanting the responsibilities — to be "in charge but not in charge." That isn't a thing. You're either running it or you're not.

"If you want my money, treat me like an investor. Come and pitch some ideas. That's how a real business works." — Corie

2. The team is better. The habits are worse.

A central observation from the session: the current team is the strongest line-up the business has ever had. And yet results are down compared to a few months ago. Multiple reps default to a comforting explanation: "we had better people back then." That explanation is wrong, and clinging to it actively prevents the fix.

What was actually different at peak

- Daily morning training. Every weekday, without exception.
- A 10:30 catch-up to drill specific scripts and objection handling.
- Daily input from a lead-gen team feeding qualified prospects in.
- "Spin to Win" — a routine that ran consistently.
- Constant pressure and presence from leadership.

Every one of those is a habit — a discipline practised daily. None of them is a person. The peak was produced by routines, not by which specific reps were in the room. The current team has the same or better raw talent. What it doesn't have is the daily discipline that compounded the talent into results.

"You've got the best team we've ever had. They're performing average because the habits dropped. Bad habits in, bad results out. It's not the team. It's the routine." — Corie (paraphrased)

The recovery protocol

1. Audit what was running daily at your last peak month. Write the list.
2. Identify which habits stopped and when.
3. Restart them. Not 80% — actually restart them, same cadence, same intensity.
4. Watch what happens over the next 6–8 weeks.

3. The unsung-hero principle

Drawing on the Beckham–Neville analogy: every front-line performer in sport has someone behind them feeding the ball at exactly the right moment. The performance you see is built on the work you don't see.

"When people talk about heroes, I ask who's the guy in the back feeding him. There's always one." — Corie

Translation for the sales floor

The same logic applies here. A sales rep's closing rate is downstream of the quality of leads they're fed and the quality of coaching they've been drilling. When those two inputs are healthy, even an average rep produces strong numbers. When those two inputs degrade, even a top-tier rep struggles.

Practical implication: senior reps should look at their numbers and ask not only "how did I sell this week?" but also "what state are the lead-gen feed and the daily training routine in?" Those upstream inputs are where most of the leverage lives.

4. Individual strengths, working as a unit

The session called out that the three senior reps have distinctly different strengths. Building an effective leadership unit means identifying those strengths, leaning into them, and covering each other's blind spots.

How to think about this

- **Discipline-lead.** Owns the daily training, the routine, the structure. Makes sure no day drifts.
- **People-lead.** Owns the relationships — internal team morale and external client warmth. Reads the room.
- **Knowledge-lead.** Owns the playbook, the case studies, the technical material. Builds the assets the rest of the team uses.

Nobody is good at all three. The trap is assuming you should be. The play is to identify which one you genuinely are, double down on it, and trust your peers to cover the other two. Then cross-train each other from those strengths.

5. The punch-card model

Corie's mental model for life decisions: you start with a blank punch card. Every action you take either punches a hole in the "profitable" column or in the "unprofitable" column. Your job is to maximise profitable punches across the available time.

Why this is harder than it sounds

- Unprofitable holes don't just sit there — they force you to recalibrate just to break even. Every bad decision steals two future good decisions.
- Emotions are the most dangerous input, because they produce decisions you didn't consciously make. Self-awareness is what turns emotional decisions into conscious ones.
- Win a client, lose a client = zero-sum. The reps who win consistently aren't the ones who win more — they're the ones who lose less.

"You make a mistake, lose \$2, then make \$40. You monetise off the back. Don't just break even on it. Anything positive you do — hold on to that and use it for life. Don't let it out of the bag." — Corie

6. The good-feel inversion

A blunt principle that shows up across the session: the things that feel good in the moment are usually the things that harm your future. The things that feel bad in the moment are usually the things that build it.

The trap	The build
Feels good now	Feels bad now
Skipping the morning training session	Showing up to morning training session you don't feel like attending
Ordering pizza instead of cooking	Cooking the meal yourself
Comfortable routine, no surprises	Uncomfortable challenges that stretch you
Going easy on the team to avoid friction	Holding the team to standards even when it's unpopular

The rule: if a habit feels good in the moment, double-check whether it's actually serving you. If it feels bad in the moment, double-check whether it's actually the thing you should be doing more of. Discipline is the trained ability to override the feel-good signal.

7. Hard now, easy later — the career-cusp window

A pointed reminder about timing. The senior reps are at a specific life-stage: no kids, no mortgage, no major dependents. That window — which the session called the "career cusp" — is the cheapest time in life to build hard. The cost of effort right now is the lowest it will ever be.

"You're at the cusp of your career. No house, no family, no little kids running around. Now's the time to drive. Build the space." — Corie

Why "build the space" matters

Within a few years the same reps will likely have partners, children, mortgages, and the energy and attention demands that come with them. Whatever financial, professional, and skill base they want to be operating from at that point has to be built now — because the hours and headspace available to build it shrink dramatically once the personal demands arrive.

This isn't a recommendation to ignore relationships or rest. It is a recommendation to be honest about the trade-off: the easy choice right now produces the hard life later. The hard choice right now produces the easy life later.

8. Self-awareness as the meta-skill

Above all the specific habits and techniques in this session, the underlying skill being asked for is self-awareness. The reps who improve fastest are the ones who can honestly observe their own behaviour and identify, without ego protection, what is and isn't working.

A practical self-awareness audit

- What habit did I have at my last peak month that I no longer have today?
- When I lost a deal this week, was my first thought a reason or a solution?
- When did I last drill an objection script with a colleague (not on a live call)?
- When did I last hold the team to a standard that made me unpopular?
- When did I last make a decision because it felt good versus because it was profitable?

Answer those honestly once a week. The pattern will surface within a month.

9. Discipline requires triggers, not motivation

A useful sidebar in the session: discipline is not the same as motivation. Motivation comes and goes. Discipline is what you have left when motivation isn't there.

The trick to running discipline reliably is to set up triggers — external systems or thoughts that move you from "I can't be bothered" to "I have to act." Corie used a memorable personal example: he uses extreme framing ("divorce on the horizon") to get himself off the couch to do small chores. It's a manufactured urgency. Most disciplined operators do something similar.

Trigger examples you can use

- Pre-block the morning training session in everyone's calendar as a non-moveable meeting.
- Announce your weekly target publicly at standup. Public commitment is its own trigger.
- Pair up with a colleague for daily drilling — accountability becomes external.
- Set a personal alarm at the exact time you'll begin a hard task. When it rings, you go — no negotiation.

10. Tactical sidebar — handling a flaky prospect

A short, direct technique from the end of the session. When you can't tell if a prospect is a real buyer or a time-waster, drop the pleasantries and ask one unapologetic question that gives them permission to be honest.

The script

"Look, I won't apologise if I sound too direct, but I also don't want you to feel obligated to come on board if it's not right for you. You're more than welcome to

tell me now if it's not. Alternatively, I can give you a call in three days, or in a week — what would you prefer?"

Why it works

- It gives the prospect permission to opt out cleanly — most people are relieved to have that option.
- It draws a real distinction between "not for me" (which you want to hear quickly) and "not yet" (which is a real follow-up).
- It forces a specific next step (three days or a week), removing the open-ended drift that wastes follow-up time.
- It signals rock-solid energy — you're busy, you're calm, and you don't need them.

11. Behaviours to change this week

5. **Treat yourself as the operator.** Stop waiting for Corie to identify the next move. Identify it yourself and pitch it.
6. **Restart daily training.** Same cadence as at peak. Not "we'll try" — actually on the calendar, actually attended, every day.
7. **Audit your peak month.** Write the list of habits you had then. Compare to now. Restart the missing ones.
8. **Pick your lane.** Discipline, people, or knowledge — choose the one you're strongest at and double down. Trust your peers to cover the others.
9. **Hold the standard.** Where the team has drifted, pull them back to it. Yes, it will be unpopular short-term. That's the job.
10. **Override the feel-good signal.** When a decision feels good in the moment, run the check: is this profitable or just comfortable?
11. **Use the flaky-prospect script.** When you can't read the room — ask the direct question. Give them permission to opt out.

Final reminder. The team is better. The habits are worse. That is good news, because the team is the hard thing to build and the habits are the easy thing to restore. The work this week is on restoring discipline — not on hoping the market changes, not on waiting for new staff, not on blaming external conditions. Restart the routines. Watch the results follow.